



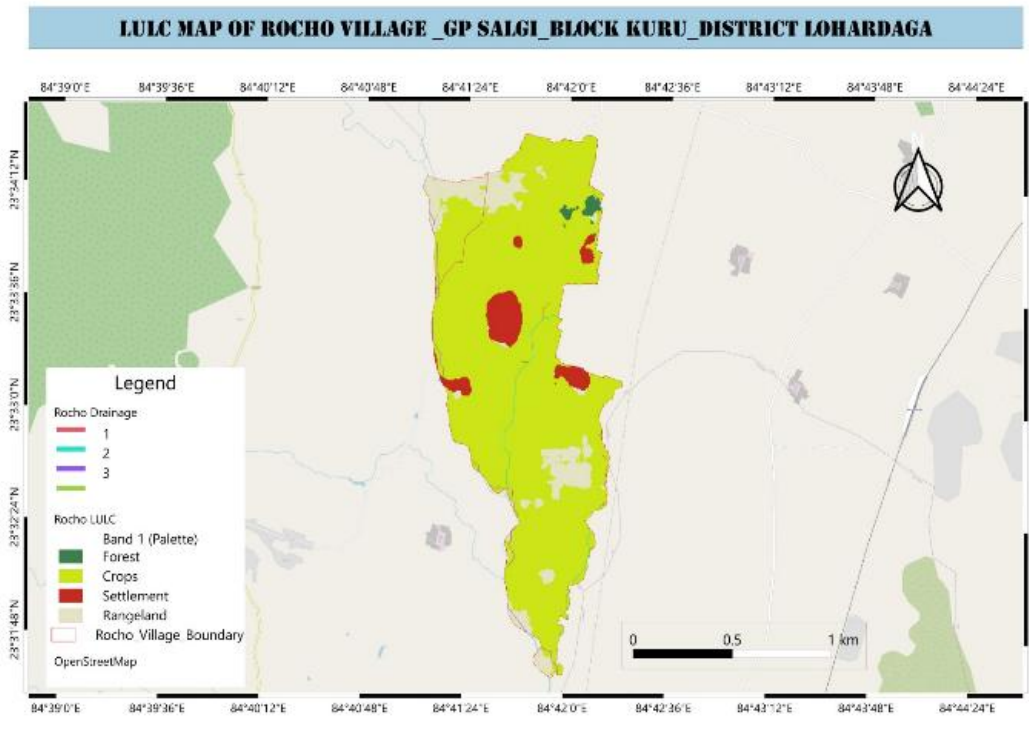
About the

Rocho

Village

Rocho village is located in Salgi Panchayat of Kuru Block, Lohardaga district, Jharkhand. The village is predominantly inhabited by Scheduled Tribe (ST) communities, reflecting the larger demographic character of the region, where indigenous communities play a central role in social, cultural, and economic life.

Rocho is a small agrarian village, with households primarily dependent on agriculture, horticulture, and livestock rearing. Landholding patterns are largely small and marginal, and farming is traditionally rainfed, making livelihoods vulnerable to climatic variability. The village follows a close-knit social structure, with strong traditions of mutual support, collective decision-making, and community action.



Community Participation and Livelihood Diversification

Rocho village has **11 women's Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** and one **Village Organization**, along with an active men's group. **Eighty Five women members** are shareholders of the Senem Nirem Farmer Producer Company (FPC) and are actively engaged in various livelihood activities such as **organic input production, nursery development, and marketing**.

This collective approach has strengthened **self-reliance, confidence, and leadership** among farmers, enabling them to envision and plan a secure future.

Area and Household level progress

S. No.	Indicator (Member Participation)	Number
1	Total households	260
2	Women SHGs	11
3	Men's SHG	1
4	FPO shareholders	85
5	Families practicing trellis (machan) farming (avg. 25 decimals)	42
6	Families with 49 acres of mango orchards	55
7	Families with goat sheds	25
8	Families practicing organic vegetable cultivation (avg. 25 decimals)	196
9	Families practicing grafted vegetable cultivation	18
10	Families with organic kitchen gardens	196
11	Families practicing organic paddy with relay crops (avg. 45 decimals)	126
12	Families practicing mixed cropping of pulses oilseeds and millets in orchards (mango-based)	176
	Families practicing mixed cropping in orchards (Intensive Vegetables)	128
13	Families with poultry sheds	46
14	Semialata plantation (lac host plants, avg. 15 decimals)	7
15	Super Napier fodder cultivation (avg. 15 decimal)	25
16	Compost units	80
17	Bio-Input Resource Centre (BRC)	1

Area Based Indicators

- Out of 391 ha of cultivable area, 19 ha under Agro- horticulture Orchard, Irrigated area 102 ha , 61 ha under Natural Farming, Forest claim -16.5 ha

Converting unproductive upland to climate resilient livelihood solution

Rocho village, is home to **260 Scheduled Tribe (ST) families**. The hamlet has now transitioned to **natural farming**, with all families consistently following natural farming practices for the last three years.

The village has 7 hamlet consisting of has a **-49 acre mango orchard**, out of which 42 acres has been completely rejuvenated and managed using organic and scientific practices. Interventions focused on **soil health improvement, ecological pest management, and scientific orchard management**. Strong market linkages have been established through the **Senem Nirem Farmer Producer Company (FPC)**.

As a result, the mango orchard has emerged as a **high-value and profitable enterprise**. Families are now earning approximately **₹1.2 lakh per year** from mango orchards and intercrops. Over the last two years, with the support of the FPO, villagers have collectively earned **₹23 lakh** from mango-based livelihoods. Continuous organic interventions have significantly improved **soil quality, crop productivity, and the overall local ecosystem**.



At present, around **154 acres** in Rocho village are under natural farming, covering the following practices:

- ✓ **Multilayer cropping systems**, integrating fruits, vegetables, and pulses.
- ✓ **Azolla pits and cultivation on raised beds**, supporting soil fertility and moisture retention.
- ✓ Cultivation of **pulses, oilseeds, nutrition gardens, Semialata (for lac cultivation), and Super Napier (fodder)**, enhancing both nutrition security and income.
- ✓ **Intercropping in horticulture systems**.
- ✓ **Paddy cultivation with relay cropping**.
- ✓ **Vegetable cultivation on permanent raised beds**.
- ✓ Regular use of bio inputs, leading to improved soil health and better-quality produce.



Impact and Way Forward

The transformation in Rocho village is clearly visible:

- Significant **increase in household income** through diversified livelihoods.
- Increase area under **round the year vegetation** through Agro-horticulture and Irrigation
- Producer groups conducted **₹16 lakh worth of business through the FPO** in the last financial year.
- Improved **soil health** and reduced dependence on chemical fertilizers.
- Enhanced **nutritional security and crop diversity**.
- Increased **community awareness, collective action, and local leadership**.

*Inspired by Rocho's success, natural farming is now being expanded to neighboring villages. Rocho has also emerged as a **learning and demonstration site under the National Mission on Natural Farming (NMNF)**. The village stands as a strong example of how collaboration between communities, Farmer-Producer Organizations, and government institutions can create a **sustainable and prosperous rural future**.*

Vegetation Coverage Change



Vegetation Coverage Change



Government Support

- ➔ Agro-Horti culture, Irrigation, Packaging Centre, Poultry shed, etc
- ➔ Turmeric processing machine provided by the Agriculture Department.
- ➔ Subsidized **drip irrigation systems** under *Per Drop More Crop*.
- ➔ Subsidized supply of **pulse seeds and organic inputs** to all 60 families.
- ➔ **Vermi bed units** provided to 23 families by Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK).
- ➔ Vegetable seeds supplied under subsidy by **ICAR, Palandu**.
- ➔ Regular field visits and technical guidance by **ICAR scientists, Palandu**.
- ➔ **Crop insurance coverage** for all 32 families.
- ➔ **Pashu Dhan vikas Yojna** extended to 11 families.

Collective Village Initiatives and Key Highlights

- ➔ Efforts towards developing a **plastic-free village**.
- ➔ **Collective orchard management**.
- ➔ Establishment of **community waste disposal systems**.
- ➔ Village beautification through **voluntary labour (Shramdaan)**.
- ➔ **Regular night meetings (Ratri Chaupals)** for collective decision-making.
- ➔ Repair of the village water tower machinery through **community contributions and collective action**.
- ➔ Six families have initiated **new livelihood enterprises** linked to organic farming.
- ➔ Regular **Shramdaan** to strengthen all livelihood-related activities.

Shramdan(Community Contribution)





Natural Farming Practices



Intercropping and Horticulture





Thank You